Phishing Awareness Guide

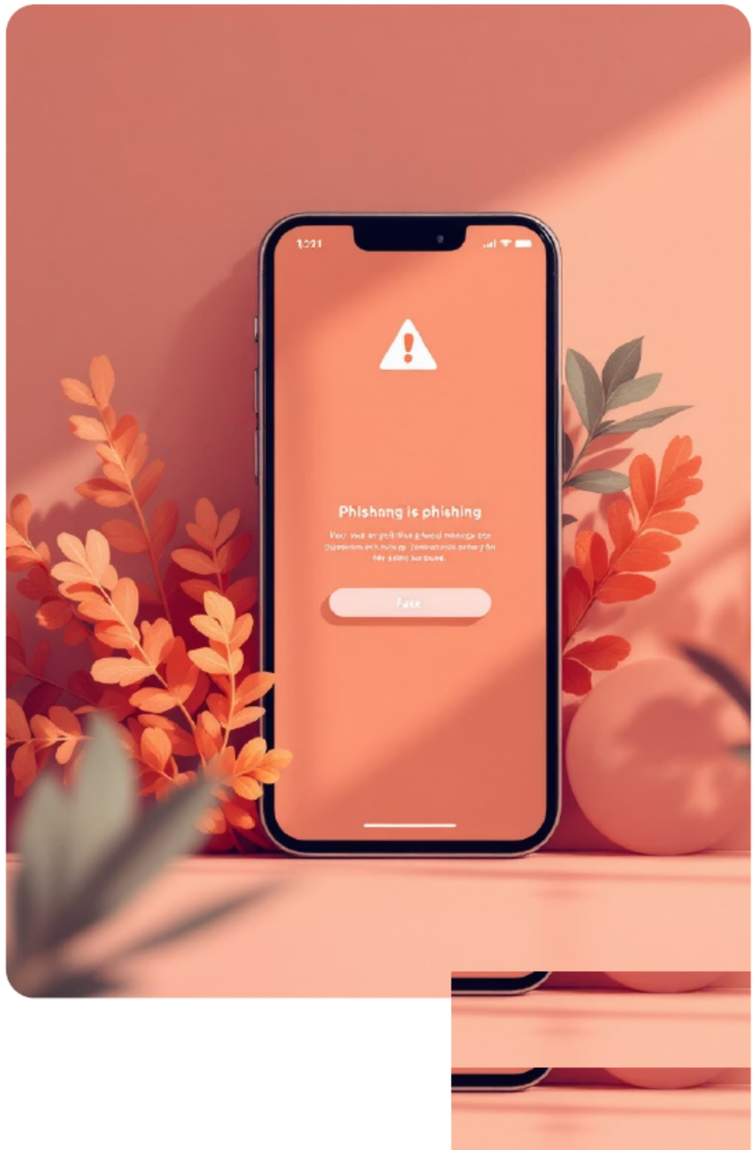
Protecting Yourself and Your Family in the Digital Age

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a deceptive attack where criminals send fake messages via email, SMS, or messaging apps to trick you into revealing sensitive information or downloading malicious software.

These messages appear legitimate but are carefully crafted to steal your:

- Personal passwords and account credentials
- One-time passwords (OTPs)
- Financial information
- Private data



Why You Should Care

Financial Loss

Unauthorized transactions and drained bank accounts can happen within minutes of clicking a malicious link.

Account Takeover

Hacked accounts can be used to impersonate you, damage your reputation, and access more sensitive information.

Data Theft

Personal photos, documents, and private information can be stolen and sold on the dark web.

Common Phishing Scenarios

Attackers use emotional triggers like fear or excitement to rush you into making mistakes. Watch out for these classic tactics:

Urgent Account Warnings

"Your bank account will be blocked immediately if you don't act now"

Unexpected Prizes

"Congratulations! You've won a prize" — especially when you didn't enter any contest

Delivery Failures

"Your package couldn't be delivered" with a suspicious tracking link

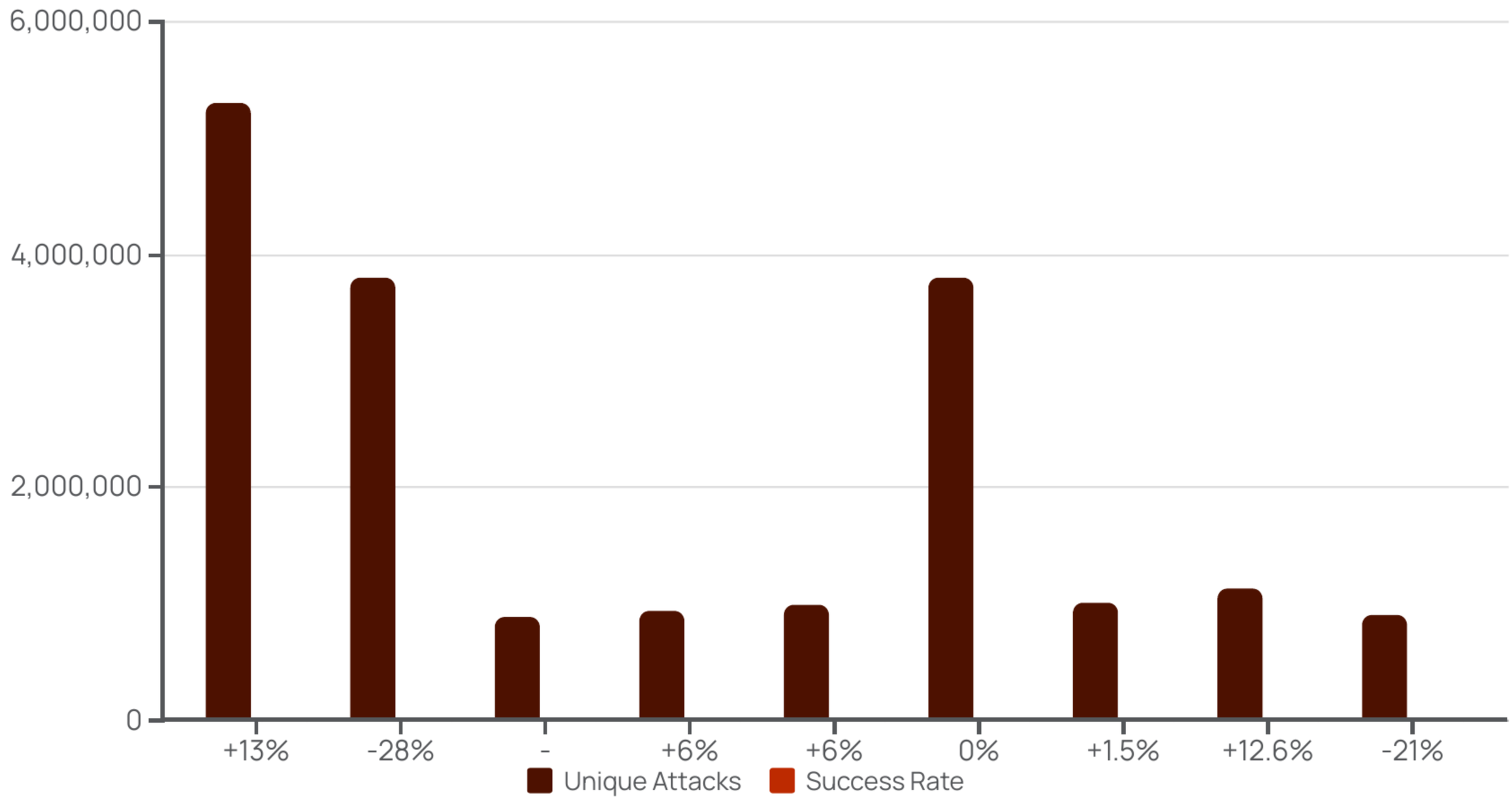
How to Identify Fake Messages

Warning Signs to Watch For

- **Suspicious sender addresses:** Check if the email domain looks strange or misspelled
- **Urgent language:** "Act now!" or "Immediate action required" pressures you to skip thinking
- **Generic greetings:** Messages saying "Dear User" instead of your name
- **Strange links:** Hover over links to see the actual destination URL
- **Unexpected attachments:** Files you weren't expecting to receive

Phishing Attack Trends Over Time

Phishing attacks have increased significantly as cybercriminals refine their techniques. Staying informed about trends helps you recognize evolving threats.



The steady increase in phishing attacks demonstrates the growing importance of cybersecurity awareness. Each year brings more sophisticated and targeted attempts to trick users.

What NOT to Do

→ Never click unknown links

Even if the message looks legitimate, verify by visiting the official website directly instead of clicking embedded links.

→ Don't download attachments

Unexpected files may contain malware that infects your device when opened.

→ Never share passwords or OTPs

Legitimate organizations will never ask for your password or one-time code via email or text.

→ Don't trust reward messages

If you didn't enter a contest, you didn't win a prize. These are almost always scams.

What You SHOULD Do

01

Check sender details carefully

Verify the complete email address or phone number. Look for misspellings in domains.

02

Visit official websites

Type the website address directly into your browser instead of using links in messages.

03

Ask for help if unsure

When in doubt, contact your IT department, bank, or the organization directly using official contact methods.

04

Delete suspicious messages

Don't hesitate to delete messages that raise any red flags. When in doubt, throw it out.

Protection for Everyone

For Families

- Teach children to never click unknown links or download apps without permission
- Set up parental controls and filters on devices
- Create a culture of asking before sharing personal information online

For Employees

- Verify work-related emails with colleagues before taking action
- Report suspicious messages to your IT security team immediately
- Follow company security policies and attend training sessions

Essential Security Practices

- Use strong, unique passwords for each account
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) wherever possible
- Keep your operating system, apps, and antivirus software updated

Think Before You Click

Cyber attackers target people, not just systems. Your awareness is your first and best protection against phishing attacks.

Stay Alert

Be skeptical of urgent messages and too-good-to-be-true offers

Verify First

Always confirm through official channels before taking action

Protect Together

Share knowledge with family and colleagues to build collective security